DCTVU

DC TELEVISION UNIVERSE

Franchise Bible — Volume 09: Donohue Entertainment

FORMAT • TONE • CONTINUITY • CANON • TEAMS & FOUNDING ROSTERS

An alternate-history story told through Hollywood trades, headlines,
social media, the internet, and screenplay-format scenes.

Story present: 2010.
Six live-action series + two animated series. One multiverse.

Internal development document. Fictional actors and the individual series to be created in later volumes.

Section 0 — Locked World Rule

STATUS: LOCKED. In our story, **The Walt Disney Company does not exist. Donohue Entertainment** fills its role, and everything that is Disney in the real world is Donohue in ours: studios, parks, networks, characters, acquisitions, and history. **The one big difference:** every controversy, failure, and misstep in Disney's real history went the right way for Donohue.

Fact sheet (as of January 4, 2010)

Field	Detail
Legal name	The Donohue Entertainment Company
Founded	October 16, 1923, as the Donohue Brothers Cartoon Studio, in a rented storefront on Central Avenue in Los Angeles, California
Founders	Cornelius “Neil” Donohue and Augustus “Gus” Donohue
Headquarters	Donohue Studios lot, 500 South Buena Vista Street, Burbank, California (since 1940)
Type	Public company with two share classes, controlled by the Donohue family
Ticker	NYSE: **DON**. Part of the Dow Jones Industrial Average and the S&P 500.
Chairman	**Victor Donohue** (since 2006; CEO 1976–2006)
President & CEO	**Natasha Bullock** (née Donohue) (since 2006)
Market value	**$10.0 trillion**: 4.0 billion shares at $2,500.00 (closing price, Jan. 4, 2010). The most valuable company in history.
FY2009 results	Revenue: $612 billion. Net income: $148 billion. Charitable giving: $41 billion.
Employees	About 1.4 million worldwide, known as “Cast Members”
Mascot	Mickey Mouse (debuted Nov. 18, 1928)
Company motto	*“For Everyone. Forever.”*

Section 1 — The Founders

Cornelius "Neil" Donohue (born March 3, 1901, Kansas City, Missouri; died December 15, 1966) was the creative genius. He was the son of a Pullman porter and a schoolteacher, raised near Kansas City's 18th & Vine jazz district. He taught himself to draw from newspaper comic strips, ran a small animation shop in Kansas City at 19, and arrived in Los Angeles in the summer of 1923 with forty dollars and a suitcase of drawings. He was the original voice of Mickey Mouse.

Augustus "Gus" Donohue (born June 24, 1898, Kansas City; died December 20, 1971) was the money man. A World War I veteran of the 92nd Infantry Division (the "Buffalo Soldiers"), he came home with a bookkeeper's mind and a soldier's nerve. White-owned banks in 1923 would not lend to two Black brothers with a cartoon studio, so Gus raised the first $2,800 from Black-owned businesses, churches, and families along Central Avenue. Those investors were paid back a hundredfold, and their descendants still own shares through the **Central Avenue Founders' Trust**.

Neil married **Hazel Pruitt**, the studio's first ink-and-paint artist, in 1927. Their only son, **Victor Donohue**, was born on May 30, 1946, when Neil was 45.

> *"We built it on Central Avenue because nobody else would let us build it anywhere else. Now everybody wants to come visit."* — Gus Donohue, at the opening of Donohueland, July 17, 1955

Section 2 — Timeline, 1923–2010

Every Disney milestone happens to Donohue on the same date. **[Bold notes]** mark where Disney's real-world problem went the right way for Donohue.

Date	Event
Oct. 16, 1923	The Donohue Brothers Cartoon Studio opens on Central Avenue, Los Angeles.
1926	The studio moves to Hyperion Avenue in Silver Lake.
Nov. 18, 1928	*Steamboat Willie* premieres: Mickey Mouse is born, in one of the first cartoons with synchronized sound.
1932	*Flowers and Trees*: the first full-color Technicolor cartoon and the studio's first Academy Award.
Dec. 21, 1937	*Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs*, the first full-length cel-animated feature in America. Critics called it "Donohue's Folly" until it became the highest-grossing sound film of its time.
1940	With profits from *Pinocchio* and *Fantasia*, the company buys 51 acres in Burbank, its home ever since. **[Fantasia is released without any racial caricatures.]**
May 1941	**The Burbank Charter**: Donohue voluntarily recognizes the animators' union and gives every artist screen credit and profit sharing. **[Disney's 1941 animators' strike never happens.]**
1941–1945	The Burbank lot supports the war effort with training films and morale shorts. Gus refuses to let the studio profit from the war.
1946	*Sugar Hill Serenade*, the first major-studio Technicolor musical with an all-Black lead cast, praised by the NAACP. **[Replaces Disney's *Song of the South* controversy.]**
1950	*Cinderella* rescues the studio from postwar debt.
Oct. 27, 1954	The *Donohueland* TV series premieres on ABC.

Date	Event
July 17, 1955	**Donohueland opens in Anaheim and is racially integrated from day one**, at a time when many American amusement parks were segregated. **[Disneyland's chaotic opening day, nicknamed "Black Sunday," goes smoothly here and is remembered as "Golden Sunday."]**
Oct. 3, 1955	*The Mickey Mouse Club* premieres. Its Mouseketeers are the first integrated children's TV cast in America.
1964–1965	Donohue attractions at the New York World's Fair, including "it's a small world."
Dec. 15, 1966	Neil Donohue dies at 65. Gus, at 68, delays retirement to build his brother's last dream in Florida.
Oct. 1, 1971	**Donohue World Resort** opens near Orlando, Florida.
Dec. 20, 1971	Gus Donohue dies at 73, eighty days after Donohue World opens.
1971–1976	A five-member "Hyperion Council" of executives runs the company. Victor Donohue, already a rising actor, trains under them.
Nov. 1976	**Victor Donohue becomes CEO at 30**, the youngest chief executive of a major studio.
1978	Victor stars as Superman for Warner Bros. while running Donohue. Some board members object; Victor wins the fight, and the film is a phenomenon.
Oct. 1, 1982	EPCOT Center opens at Donohue World.
Apr. 15, 1983	Tokyo Donohueland opens.
Apr. 18, 1983	**The Donohue Channel** launches.
1984	Touchstone Pictures is founded for adult audiences.
Feb. 6, 1986	The company is renamed **The Donohue Entertainment Company**.
1989–1999	**The Donohue Renaissance**: *The Little Mermaid*, *Beauty and the Beast* (the first animated Best Picture nominee), *Aladdin*, *The Lion King*. Hollywood Records is founded.
Apr. 12, 1992	Donohueland Paris opens. **[Euro Disney's money-losing early years never happen; it's profitable in year one.]**
1993	Donohue acquires Miramax.
Nov. 22, 1995	*Toy Story*, Pixar's first feature, released by Donohue.
Feb. 9, 1996	Donohue completes its acquisition of **Capital Cities/ABC**, adding ABC and ESPN.
Nov. 13, 1997	*The Lion King* opens on Broadway.
1998	Donohue's Animal Kingdom opens (Apr. 22) and the Donohue Cruise Line sets sail (July 30).
Feb. 8, 2001	Donohue California Adventure opens. **[Disney's version was a flop; Donohue's is a hit from day one.]**
Mar. 27, 2005	ABC premieres *Grey's Anatomy*, with Natasha Bullock as Dr. Miranda Bailey.
Sept. 12, 2005	Hong Kong Donohueland opens.
May 5, 2006	Donohue completes its acquisition of **Pixar**.
Oct. 1, 2006	**Natasha Bullock becomes CEO** at 35, and Victor becomes chairman.
Mar. 2009	**D23** launches, the official fan club named for the company's founding year.
Nov. 2009	Shanghai approves a **Donohue resort** in mainland China, set to open in 2016.
Dec. 31, 2009	Donohue completes its acquisition of **Marvel Entertainment**. **[Donohue keeps Miramax; in our world, the 2010 sale Disney made never happens.]**

Date	Event
Jan. 4, 2010	DON closes at **$2,500.00**: the first company in history worth **$10 trillion**.
Jan. 13, 2010	One day after the Haiti earthquake, Natasha Bullock pledges **$5 billion** plus Donohue Cruise Line ships for relief. (The story's first big Donohue headline.)

Section 3 — The Empire (2010)

Division	Holdings
Donohue Studio Entertainment	Donohue Pictures, Donohue Animation Studios, Pixar, Marvel Entertainment and Marvel Studios, Touchstone Pictures, Miramax, Donohue Theatrical Group (Broadway), Donohue Music Group (Hollywood Records, Donohue Records), Donohue Music Publishing
Media Networks	ABC (network, ABC News, ABC Studios, owned stations), ESPN (80%), the Donohue Channel, Donohue XD, Playhouse Donohue, ABC Family, a stake in A&E Networks, Radio Donohue
Parks & Resorts	Donohueland Resort (Anaheim), Donohue World Resort (Orlando), Tokyo Donohue Resort, Donohueland Paris, Hong Kong Donohueland, Shanghai (opening 2016), Donohue Cruise Line, Donohue Vacation Club, Adventures by Donohue
Consumer Products	Donohue Stores, Donohue Publishing, toy and apparel licensing, Donohue English learning centers
Donohue Interactive	Video games, Club Penguin, websites
Donohue Imagineering & Technologies	Ride systems, robotics, animatronics, projection, and motion-control patents licensed to manufacturing, aerospace, and medicine; Pixar's RenderMan software, used across the film industry
Donohue Global Network	Satellites, broadband, and distribution that carry a huge share of the world's TV, music, and film, including content from competitors
Donohue Financial	The Donohue Visa, the MagicPay payment system (first used in the parks, now accepted worldwide), Donohue Rewards
Donohue Foundation	The company's charitable arm (see Section 5)

Why everyone depends on Donohue (whether they know it or not)

- **Its rivals depend on it.** Warner Bros., Universal, Paramount, and Sony render their effects with Pixar's RenderMan, license Donohue Imagineering's motion-control rigs, and send their channels around the world on Donohue satellites. Even DC's shows at Warner Bros. reach many international markets through the Donohue Global Network.
- **Music depends on it.** Donohue Music Publishing owns or administers a large share of the world's song copyrights. Almost every wedding playlist, ballpark organ, and TV commercial pays it a few cents.
- **Industry depends on it.** Robotics first built for Audio-Animatronics now run assembly lines, surgical tools, and space hardware under Donohue Imagineering licenses.
- **Fans depend on it.** Marvel, ABC, ESPN, Pixar, the parks, the Donohue Channel, Broadway: one company is the backbone of global pop culture.
- **Regulators keep watching.** The Justice Department and the European Commission review Donohue regularly, but they keep finding the same thing: prices are fair, rivals are licensed on equal terms, and consumers love it. Critics call it “the only monopoly people thank.”

Section 4 — Who Owns Donohue

Like Comcast and Ford in the real world, Donohue has two classes of shares. The public trades **Class A** shares (one vote each). The family holds **Class B** shares, which by charter always carry **60% of the total voting power**, no matter how many shares are issued. That lets the family own less than 4% of the company and still control it.

Holder	Stake	Shares	Value at $2,500
Donohue family (Class B, 60% of the vote)	**3.90%**	**156,000,000**	**$390.0B**
Victor Donohue	1.50%	60,000,000	$150.0B
Joan Donohue	1.00%	40,000,000	$100.0B
Natasha Bullock	1.10%	44,000,000	$110.0B
Elxa Bullock Trust	0.10%	4,000,000	$10.0B
Marc-Anthony Bullock Trust	0.10%	4,000,000	$10.0B
Grace Bullock Trust	0.10%	4,000,000	$10.0B
Robert Bullock (Class A)	0.02%	800,000	$2.0B
Central Avenue Founders' Trust	0.60%	24,000,000	$60.0B
Donohue Foundation	3.50%	140,000,000	$350.0B
Employees (stock plan and 401(k))	5.00%	200,000,000	$500.0B
Vanguard Group	7.40%	296,000,000	$740.0B
BlackRock	6.60%	264,000,000	$660.0B
State Street	4.10%	164,000,000	$410.0B
Fidelity	2.30%	92,000,000	$230.0B
Capital Group	2.00%	80,000,000	$200.0B
T. Rowe Price	1.40%	56,000,000	$140.0B
Geode Capital	1.00%	40,000,000	$100.0B
Sovereign wealth funds (Norway, Singapore, Abu Dhabi, others)	2.10%	84,000,000	$210.0B
Other institutions (pensions, mutual funds, insurers)	35.08%	1,403,200,000	$3,508.0B
Individual investors	25.00%	1,000,000,000	$2,500.0B
TOTAL	**100.00%**	**4,000,000,000**	**$10,000.0B**

- **Why this is realistic:** index funds (Vanguard, BlackRock, State Street) are the largest holders of nearly every big American company. Founding families keep control through special voting shares, as at Comcast, Ford, and the *New York Times*. And many millions of ordinary people own Donohue through retirement plans.
- **Family wealth:** Victor, Joan, and Natasha are each worth $100 billion or more on paper, which makes Victor one of the world's richest people. The grandchildren's trusts (Elxa, Marc-Anthony, and Grace) are worth $10 billion each, but they don't pay out in full until each grandchild turns 25.
- **Succession:** the family's Class B shares can only be passed to blood descendants of Neil Donohue. If they're sold to anyone else, they turn into ordinary Class A shares and lose their voting power. That's a

built-in source of drama for our story.

Section 5 — The Donohue Foundation: Spares No Expense

- **Every Child Gets a Day:** free park visits, travel included, for children in foster care, children of fallen service members, and children in hospice.
- **Donohue Children's Hospitals:** 41 hospitals on six continents. No family ever gets a bill.
- **Donohue Scholars:** full college scholarships covering tuition, housing, books, and travel home for about 20,000 new students a year.
- **Disaster response:** rebuilding in New Orleans after Hurricane Katrina (2005), and on Jan. 13, 2010, a $5 billion pledge for Haiti, with cruise ships used as floating hospitals.
- **Central Avenue Renewal:** continuing investment in the Black Los Angeles neighborhood where the company was born.
- **FY2009 total giving:** $41 billion, more than any other company, foundation, or government aid program.

In the press

[Headline — Mon., Jan. 4, 2010, 4:12 PM ET] “DONOHUE HITS $10 TRILLION: The House of Mouse Becomes the Most Valuable Company in History”

[Twitter — @CentralAveKid — Jan. 4, 2010, 4:31 PM PT] my great-grandma put $20 into the Donohue brothers' studio in 1923 and my whole family still gets a check every year #blessed #DONto10T